

How is this information useful? Imagine that the measure rule predicts a rise to 37.50 from 30, a climb of 7.5 points or 25%. In bull markets, we see that 43% of complex bottoms will fail to see price exceed a 25% rise. In bear markets it's even worse, with 62% failing to exceed the target. Such big failure rates may make you adjust your expectations.

[Table 40.4](#) shows breakout-related statistics.

Breakout direction. By definition the breakout is always up. If price breaks out downward first (by closing below the bottom of the pattern), then it's not a valid complex bottom.

Yearly position, performance. The best performing complex bottoms vary depending on market conditions. In bull markets, for example, the best performing break out in the middle third of the yearly high-low price range.

In bear markets, those within a third of the yearly low do best.

I think the bull market results are suspicious. Rarely do patterns in the middle range perform well, but complex bottoms show an exception.

Throwbacks. A throwback occurs in about two-thirds of the complex bottoms. Price breaks out upward, peaks in an average of 6 days, and returns to the breakout price for a round-trip of 12 days.

When a throwback occurs, performance suffers. That may surprise you, but it is common for chart patterns. My thinking is that a throwback robs upward momentum. The key is to search for overhead resistance before trading and to avoid it when possible.